

as the private cloud. There are companies building their own private clouds, which cater to their in-house or group requirements. Second is the Public Cloud Services. These are cloud services providers like Tata Communications, BSNL Reliance Communications, Bharti Airtel, HCL Infosystems, etc. These companies deliver IT as a service to the end user. Going a step ahead, what we started witnessing was that there were a large number of companies looking at the areas in which they could utilise the public cloud services from service providers and the areas where it made more sense to use the technologies within their own data centres—to bring about more efficiency within their own data centres for creating their own private clouds. Third area is where people are talking of creating a hybrid cloud in which their production system is on their private cloud. And as the data ages, they push it to the public cloud services. This may include archival data that they may need to keep for compliance purposes over a longer period.”

The hybrid cloud is one of the fastest emerging models today, where, depending on the requirements of the application, the data resides within the data centre in a private cloud environment and when it ages, gets moved onto a public cloud service. Also, large enterprises in India don't place their sales force automation applications within their own data centre. They use salesforce.com or SFDC, as it is called. A large number of companies in India are deploying it for their own sales forces. Ramco Systems, which is dominant in the ERP systems deployment space today, is also a cloud-enabled company. A mid-sized company looking at an ERP solution need not set up its own data centre and deploy an application within it. The solution can be hosted with Ramco and the latter will deliver it as a service to the end customer. So ERP as a service is being delivered too.

The cloud revolution in India is more need-based. Awasthi highlights what drives this trend:

1. With respect to the storage area or IT infrastructure, one of the trends is for cloud services providers to deploy a shared IT-as-a-service environment, which would be delivered in a secured multi-tenant way to its end customers. So, they are not placing physically independent systems at the disposal of each customer but deploying a single environment in which they put in technologies that help to create a secure multi-tenancy environment. The cloud services companies are working on creating those environments. Indian companies are ready to look at this option when they deploy their business applications within their data centre or cloud services arena.
2. The second area where there is a lot of enthusiasm is in disaster recovery or business continuity. Today, businesses are heavily dependant on IT. Instead of setting their own data centre in a different seismic zone, companies are adopting Disaster Recovery as

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a Service (DRaaS) with the service provider offering different SLAs (service-level agreement).

3. The third area gaining traction is businesses going in for off-site back-up for long-term archival solutions. For example, telecom companies have to keep CDRs (call detail records) for several years as per the regulations of the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India. For this, telcos are looking towards cloud services providers rather than keeping the data in their own data centres. Similar solutions are needed in the banking sector. Banks are supposed to keep the details of transactions of each customer for a period of three-four years—so an archival solution with the cloud services providers would be ideal.

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